

CAPULIATO SICILIANO

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Makes: About 750 ml of pesto

Cook Time: 45 minutes

For this recipe, you will need:

- 2 pounds (900 g) sun-dried tomatoes
- About 10 fresh basil leaves (optionally, keep some extra on hand for layering in the jar)
- 2 cloves garlic, peeled
- 2 fresh or dry chili peppers (optional)
- Dried oregano (optional)
- Extra-virgin olive oil

Using a meat grinder, grind the sun-dried tomatoes into a large mixing bowl using a coarse setting. As the tomatoes grind, periodically add some of the basil, garlic, and chili peppers into the grinder as well. When all of the tomatoes are processed, give them a stir to evenly mix in the herbs and peppers.

Begin filling a 1 liter, wide mouth jar with the tomato mix. As you add the tomatoes into the jar, press them down very firmly with a spoon or other long pressing implement (if your meat grinder came with a pressing mallet, that's perfect). The tomatoes need to be very compact to eliminate air in the jar.

When the pressed tomatoes reach about 2 inches (5 cm) high in the jar, you can optionally add a sprinkle of oregano and 1 to 2 basil leaves before continuing to add tomatoes. Keep layering a couple inches of tomatoes, followed by basil and oregano, until all of the tomato mix is pressed into the jar.

Finish the capuliato with one last sprinkle of oregano and some basil. Fill with olive oil to completely cover all, then wait about 15 minutes. If the olive oil soaks down into the tomatoes, keep adding a little more to keep the tomatoes covered.

Capuliato siciliano will last in the fridge for several months. Be sure that, every time you use some, to press the remainder flat in the jar and cover again with olive oil.

Buon appetito!